

Incident Alert 0011. TLP CLEAR.		Date	Breakout Scale
Title	FR - Political Ads from Mali Targeting French Muslim Voters on FB, IG, and Meta Audience Network.	12/06/2024	1

Summary

- Between April 29 and June 11, 2024, a Facebook page posted 15 unlabelled political ads targeting French voters.
- The page targets French Muslim users and uses ads to discredit France in relation to the Israel-Hamas war and their alleged bad treatment of Muslim minorities.
- In total, the ads have managed to reach 59k users on Facebook, Instagram and Meta's Audience Network.
- The two accounts administering the page are from Mali according to Facebook's transparency centre.

Incident – When, Who did what, to say what, to whom, why?

Between April 29 and June 11, 2024, the Facebook page “Musulmans de France” posted 15 unlabelled political ads targeting French voters ([x](#)).

The Facebook page was created on April 16, 2024, and is managed by two accounts from Mali ([x](#)). The page's first ad was funded by "Actualités et Infos en Afrique". "Actualités et Infos en Afrique" was originally created as "Les actus régionales en France" in January 2022, and was renamed in February 2024. An article from Burkina24 mentions a social media agency called "SMM and Development Agency in Africa," which operates from Mali and ran pages supporting Macron ([x](#)). This article claims that "Les actus régionales en France" might be such a pages.

It is unclear if "Musulmans de France" is connected to the social media agency. However, given the non-commercial nature of the content, the Malian origin of the administrators, and the page's advertisements, it is likely backed by an entity funded externally. If the same actor is behind this page, they might have shifted their focus to discredit Macron under a new contract.

Narrative

Meta narrative: Macron and his government are Islamophobic, Exploitation of Immigrants, Puppet of the U.S.
Sub: Macron supports Israel, attacks Azerbaijan for supporting New Caledonia,, sending Muslims to Ukraine.

Impact

Reach: In total, the ads reached 60k users on Facebook, Instagram and Meta's Audience Network. The page itself has 1.3k followers. Between March 20 and June 10, the six ad-boosted posts got around 25k likes, 720 comments, and 620 shares altogether.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

The Facebook page's likely objective is to [Smear](#) their political opponents.

[Create Personas](#) – Identifying itself as a group of French Muslims while seemingly primarily operating from Mali.

[Deliver Ads](#) – Using ads to reach their target audience without revealing the ads' funding source.

[Manipulate Platform Algorithm](#) – Ads were edited to make the text harder to machine-read

Recommendations

- Action taken: CIB network reported to Meta and X 01/04/2024 – pending response.
- Further investigation into the page is needed to determine for sure who is operating it.
- Name and Shame: highlight the page's attempts to manipulate the French population.

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Content type	Platforms
N/A	Racism, Ukraine, New Caledonia	N/A	Saman Nazari , A4E	Ads, FB posts.	Facebook.